acts, engage in self-censorship, and even punish our own workers for offending China.

When British prime minister Theresa May lauded the current "golden era of UK-China relations" on a visit to Beijing in January 2018, she was simply repeating what every national leader says in the face of China's economic clout.[51] Though the West has long known that a significant part of China's success has come through stealing intellectual property and pressuring foreign companies to give up their trade secrets, it has looked the other way in the name of profits and affordable goods. Now Beijing is raising the price of doing business in China, demanding that its foreign partners surrender Western values and openly espouse China's worldview for continued access to its markets.

One might expect only smaller companies, like Palau Pacific Airways, not major multinationals, to heed Chinese wishes, but such is not the case. Even international corporations are willing to kowtow to China. In February 2018, German car giant Daimler-Benz ran afoul of Beijing after committing the sin of quoting the exiled Tibetan spiritual leader the Dalai Lama in a social media ad—an ad not even run in China. The company abjectly apologized in the face of Chinese demands not once but twice "to the Chinese people." Soberly noting the "seriousness of the situation," the company solemnly averred that it offers "no support, assistance, aid or help to anyone who intentionally subverts or attempts to subvert China's sovereignty and territorial integrity."[52] That a twelve-word ad caused such an extraordinary display of corporate groveling not only revealed Beijing's insecurities, but also made clear that China now knows it can get away with bringing corporate titans to their public knees. Just over a year later, in August 2019, heralded Hong Kong airline Cathay Pacific fired its CEO after Beijing pressured the company over employees' participation in the massive prodemocracy demonstrations in Hong Kong. Chinese officials further demanded that Cathay flight crew members who took part in demonstrations be barred from flying to China.[53] The airline's new CEO agreed to the demands.